

AE Course Syllabus

Spring 2025

- **Course Description:**

Academic English Writing for Mechanical and Electrical Engineering is an English language course for undergraduates from the *Haixue College*. Please note that as an extended course of *College English series*, it is a **compulsory** course.

This course does not use a text book. However, a list of references is included at the back of the syllabus. Specifically, please follow the directions of **task sheets** in each lecture.

8 lectures in total, which will include the following topics: 1) vocabulary choice, 2) hedging & nominalization, 3) sentence structure, 4) reporting verbs, 5) plagiarism & paraphrasing, 6) summarizing & describing, 7) analyzing & evaluation, and 8) discourse cohesion.

- **Course Objectives:**

It aims to foster the general competence of writing academic English among students within related majors.

And also, the course explains each step by showcasing authentic academic material in related fields, with a highlight in discovering the pattern of academic English.

- **Course Duration and Frequency:**

1 semester, 8 weeks; 2 hours per week, 16 lectures in total; 1 credit.

- **Course Difficulty Level:**

Medium to Strong—Requiring students to follow teacher's instructions and finish corresponding tasks on time.

It is VERY IMPORTANT for you to keep on the same page with the whole class.

- **Assessment Formation:**

Class Performance (50%)

✓ Attendance— 10 points in total; 5 points will be deducted for each absence

- ✓ Regular quizzes— 5 in-class quizzes (40 points in total, questions selected from **task sheet exercises**); the quizzes will be in **Week 2, 3, 4, 5, 6**.
- ✓ Class participation— voluntary participations of answering questions in class (2 bonus points for each participation, with a limit of 10 points or when your total score hits 100)

Final (50%) Time: the last in-class period

- ✓ Close-book examination— 45 mins in-class test, covering all topics of the course.

Please **NOTE** that if you fail in the course assessment, you will not get the 1 compulsory credit from this course until you pass the make-up test in the next semester. However, there will be a record of failing the course in your academic transcript.

- **Requirements:**

1. Complete questions in each task sheet exercise, as they will be tested in the quizzes.
2. Perform well on your examinations.
3. Be prepared and volunteer to answer questions in class.

- ♪ **Reference Books & Materials:**

1. Stephen Bailey. *Academic Writing: A handbook for international students (5th Ed.)* [M]. London: Routledge, 2018.
2. 蔡基刚. 学术英语(理工)(第二版)[M]. 北京: 外语教学与研究出版社, 2024.
3. 夏历, 郭巍. 英文学术论文写作--改评析[M]. 北京航空航天大学出版社, 2020.
4. 杨玉, 等. 理工学术英语[M]. 北京: 清华大学出版社, 2021.

♥ I wish you all good luck for the brand new semester😊